

Sulitânia

SYFERS Repository — What it is and what it asks of us

April 2026 · For members and active contributors

The REINFORCING grant application was rejected on an administrative error. Not on content. Not on approach. The rejection changes nothing about what we are building — but it gives us a chance to be clearer about *why* we are doing it.

This document explains what the SYFERS repository is, why it fits what Sulitânia already does, and what it means concretely for the people who live and work here.

1. What is the SYFERS repository?

A GitHub repository is a public folder on the internet. Documents, templates, protocols, monitoring data — all organised, readable and findable by anyone.

SYFERS stands for Syntropic Framework for Encoding Regenerative Societies. The name sounds heavy, but the idea is simple:

What Sulitânia learns, we build in such a way that others can use it without starting from zero.

The repository documents three things:

- What we have already done — food forest, energy, governance, meetings, assemblies.
- How we did it — processes, templates, lessons, mistakes.
- What others can replicate — guides that stand independent of Sulitânia-specific context.

This is not an academic project. It is institutional memory — the kind that currently lives in people's heads, in notes, in folders, and disappears when people leave.

2. Why do this without a subsidy?

Three reasons.

2.1 Future funding

DLBC, LEADER, the next REINFORCING round in 2026–2027 — all these funds ask not just for plans. They ask for evidence. A repository with structured data from two years of practice is stronger evidence

than the most beautifully written application without documentation.

The repository we build now is the foundation for every future application. Time invested now in documentation saves three times that in the next submission.

2.2 What we do has value for others

There are hundreds of communities across Europe trying to build something similar. Syntropic farming, consent governance, community energy, cooperative housing. Most start from zero because there are no good models accessible to them.

Sulitânia has two years of experience, real measurement data, real mistakes, real lessons. That has value. Sharing that knowledge is not a loss — it grows the network and the credibility of what we are doing here.

2.3 It belongs to our values

Transparency is how trust is built and maintained. Documentation is memory — what is not written down does not exist as institutional knowledge. That is in our manifesto.

A repository is the concrete expression of that value. Not as obligation. As practice.

3. What are the ORRI principles and what do they have to do with us?

ORRI stands for Open and Responsible Research and Innovation — a European framework that describes how organisations can structure their work when they take seriously that knowledge is a public good.

There are 10 principles. Below are the four most visible in our daily work:

ORRI principle	What Sulitânia already does
Inclusive governance	Consent governance, 32 working meetings documented, 3 assemblies
Societal goals	7 nationalities, regenerative agriculture, open volunteer programme
Monitoring & accountability	Soil analysis, planting records (1,688 plants), energy data
Open innovation	SSAAFLab, tiny house prototype, governance as experiment

The point is this: we already do almost everything the ORRI principles describe. What is missing is structure and accessibility. The repository makes it findable, readable and usable.

4. What does this mean in daily practice?

This is the question that matters most. Below is what the repository means concretely per domain.

4.1 Ecology — food forest and SSAFLab

What already exists:

- 1,688 plants of 61+ species, planted and registered.
- Soil analysis from September 2025 (Jake Corin).
- SSAFLab — 130 m² experimental plot.
- Seed bank in development.

What goes into the repository:

- A CSV with all species, Latin names, planting dates, location.
- The soil analysis as a structured document.
- An establishment guide for a syntropic food forest in Mediterranean climate.
- An experiment log for SSAFLab: hypothesis, method, result.

Concrete example — SSAFLab

Now: the experiments live in the heads of the people involved.

After: each experiment has a record — what did we want to know, what did we do, what did we observe. 20 minutes after each experiment. Cumulatively very valuable.

Others (universities, other communities, researchers) can cite, compare and build on what we have already discovered.

4.2 Governance — meetings and decision-making

What already exists:

- 3 assemblies with minutes.
- 32 working meetings documented.
- Consent governance principles (already on the website).

What goes into the repository:

- A decision log — one row per decision, with date, method and outcome.
- Anonymised assembly minutes.
- Templates for agendas, minutes and decision records.
- A description of the conflict-as-information process.

Concrete example — decision log

Now: 32 meeting minutes are spread across files. Anyone wanting to know what was decided must search through everything.

After: one table. Date Decision Method (consent / assembly) Outcome.
Four hours of work. Then: five minutes per meeting to keep up to date.
For an EU application: directly usable as evidence of participatory governance.

4.3 Energy

What already exists:

- 22.3 kWp solar energy system with 48 kWh storage.
- Installation documentation from the installer.

What goes into the repository:

- System specifications: components, capacity, costs, installation month.
- Monthly production data (once tracked).
- A replication guide: how does another community build a comparable system?

Concrete example — energy data

Now: the data is with the installer and in our heads.

After: each month the production (kWh) is entered in one row of a spreadsheet.

After one year: a curve showing how an autonomous system performs

in southern Portuguese climate. Unique and valuable data.

4.4 Social — onboarding and workshops

What already exists:

- Volunteer programme in practice (informally documented).
- 8+ workshops delivered on syntropic farming and governance.
- Multilingual website and handbook (7 languages).

What goes into the repository:

- Onboarding guide for new members and volunteers.
- Workshop log: date, topic, participants, one-sentence outcome.
- Reusable workshop template.

Concrete example — volunteer guide

Now: every new volunteer gets a verbal introduction.

The quality depends on who happens to be present.

After: a 4-page guide describing what Sulitânia is, what the expectations

are, and how daily practice works. Written once, always available.

Everyone receives the same, clear welcome.

4.5 Economy — circulation model and Friends

What already exists:

- 10% circulation model: described but not formally documented.
- 19 micro-enterprises active or in development.
- Friends of Sulitânia programme in development.

What goes into the repository:

- Description of the 10% logic: what it is, how it works, why.
- Overview of active micro-enterprises.
- Structure and tiers of the Friends programme.

The 10% model is a response to a market failure: an economy that is extractive rather than circular. Publishing that documented is a contribution to the European debate on alternative economic models.

5. What changes in how we work?

Honest answer: little, if we set it up well.

The repository is not an extra layer on top of the real work. It is the real work lightly extended with a moment of writing things down.

Moment	What is added
After a meeting	Secretary adds one row to the decision log (5 min)
After a workshop	Organiser notes date, topic, participants, one-line outcome (10 min)
After a planting day	Ecology team adds rows to the species table (15 min)
Every month	Energy responsible notes kWh production (5 min)
After each assembly	Anonymised minutes are uploaded (30 min)
Each quarter	One reflection document: what worked, what didn't, what do we learn (2 hrs)

The investment is small. The return is large: a working memory of the cooperative, and a professional foundation for every future funding application.

6. What decisions are we asked to make?

These are decisions that cannot be made by Floris or Claude. They belong to the community.

6.1 Privacy in the repository

Minutes and conflict logs contain information about individual members. Choice: fully anonymised (names removed), partially anonymised (names removed, roles kept), or only summary documents published?

Recommendation: anonymise all minutes fully. Publish the decision log in its entirety, because decisions are collective acts.

6.2 What to do with the period before formal registration

The cooperative was only formally registered in June 2025. But the most important learning happened in the period before that (May 2023–June 2025). Choice: include this history fully, partially, or only start from formal registration?

Recommendation: include the full history, with a clear note that it predates formal registration. That honesty makes it more valuable.

6.3 Language of the repository

English has the widest reach and best alignment with EU funding. Choice: English only, or English as primary language with a Portuguese README alongside?

Recommendation: English as primary language, Portuguese README alongside, key documents in both.

6.4 Who contributes?

Who may propose changes to the repository? Only Sulitânia members, or external contributors too?

Recommendation: standard open-source practice. Sulitânia controls the main branch; external contributions are welcome but reviewed before merging.

7. Phasing — when is what built?

The repository is built in phases. Each phase delivers concrete, usable files.

Phase	Content and timing
Phase 1 — Foundation (Apr–May 2026)	Repository structure, README, licence, governance principles, statutes, Living Trinity, Heal the System, Position Paper.
Phase 2 — Core evidence (May–Jun 2026)	Species table, planting plan, soil analysis, energy specs, workshop log, decision log, stakeholder map.

Phase 3 — Templates (Jun–Jul 2026)	Food forest establishment guide, governance template pack, consent guide, onboarding guide, energy replication guide.
Phase 4 — Monitoring (Jul–Sep 2026)	Indicators document, first quarterly reflection, mistakes-and-lessons log, ORRI self-assessment.
Ongoing (from Oct 2026)	Monthly energy data, planting records, minutes, workshop log, quarterly reflections.

8. In closing

The subsidy is not here. The energy is.

What Sulitânia is building is rare: a place where ecology, governance, economy and social life actually come together in daily practice. Two years of experimenting, 32 meetings, 1,688 planted plants, a soil analysis, an autonomous energy system, seven nationalities making decisions together.

That is the raw material of the repository. Not theory. Not aspirations. Documented practice.

A working repository with 30 documents is worth more than a perfect plan with zero.

We begin with what exists. We build step by step. We do it for ourselves, for the next funding application, and for everyone who wants to walk this path without starting from zero.